WayneFlow

FREE · $300 VALUE

THE WAYNEFLOW COLD EMAIL PLAYBOOK

From a blank domain to a calendar full of sales calls.

The complete, step-by-step manual setup behind 588,000 cold emails and $510K+ in client pipeline. Domains, inboxes, DNS records, warmup, lists, emails and replies, with the real numbers from our client dashboards.

588,000	3,400+	$510K+
cold emails sent for clients	buyers who asked to talk	pipeline for clients

- ✓ 17 chapters, every step by hand
- ✓ The 3-week warmup schedule
- ✓ The 10-minute daily health check
- ✓ Exact DNS records to copy
- ✓ Real emails that got replies
- ✓ 30-day launch calendar + checklists



WayneFlow by Ali & Asim
8 years in outbound · B2B clients across the USA and Canada

BEFORE YOU START

Read this first

Most cold email advice is written by people who sell software. This playbook is written by people who run campaigns. We are Ali and Asim, two cousins from Pakistan who have spent the last 8 years building outbound systems for B2B companies, mostly in the USA and Canada.

In 2026 alone our campaigns sent **588,000 cold emails** for clients. They produced **12,900+ replies**, **3,400+ buyers who said "yes, let's talk"**, and **$510K+ in qualified pipeline**. Every number in this guide comes from those live dashboards. Where we use a public rule (Google, Microsoft, the FTC), we tell you where it comes from.

HOW TO USE THIS PLAYBOOK

- **Doing it yourself?** Go chapter by chapter. Each one ends with a step you can finish the same day. Plan on about 30 days from zero to your first booked call.
- **Short on time?** Read Chapter 1 (the math) and the checklists at the end. You will know exactly what a good system needs, and how to judge anyone you hire.
- **Want it done for you?** Skip to the last page. We build and run the whole system and book the calls into your calendar.

What is inside

17 chapters in 6 parts, with 7 real case studies along the way. Click any chapter to jump to it.

PART 1 · THE PLAN

1 The math before the machine

2 Your tool stack and what it really costs

PART 2 · THE SENDING MACHINE

3 Buy the right domains

4 Google Workspace and your inboxes

5 DNS: MX, SPF, DKIM and DMARC

6 Redirects, connecting inboxes, tracking

7 Warmup: the 3-week rule

8 The 10-minute daily health check

PART 3 · THE LIST

9 Pick buyers who are ready now

10 Build and verify the list by hand

PART 4 · THE MESSAGE

11 Write emails people answer

12 Follow-ups that add something new

PART 5 · LAUNCH AND RUN

13 Launch day and the volume ramp

14 From reply to booked meeting

15 Testing and reading your numbers

PART 6 · STAY SAFE

16 The law: USA and Canada

17 When emails hit spam

TOOLS

✔ The 30-day calendar and checklists

→ Do it yourself, or let us do it

CHAPTER 1

The math before the machine

> A booked sales call is the end of a long funnel. Work backward from the calls you want, and you will know how many people you need to reach every day.

The "book 5 to 10 demos a day" guides you see online usually start with a fantasy projection: send 1,000 emails a day, get a 5% reply rate, close 16 deals. Real campaigns are messier. Here is what our real funnels looked like, with nothing rounded up.

Campaign	People contacted	Replies	Reply rate	Interested buyers	Bounce
Marketing agency, 1 quarter	76,081	2,429	3.19%	2,146	1.64%
Construction software	158,322	4,449	2.81%	31 demos held	2.87%
5-day blitz	79,587	1,095	1.38%	115 → 25 calls	0.45%
One quarter, high volume	118,387	4,372	3.69%	1,061	3.08%
Pilot campaign	10,284	417	4.05%	103 opportunities	n/a

"Interested" means the person replied with real interest: asked for details, a price, or a time to talk. Pipeline is counted at our clients' average deal size of about $2,500.

The funnel, in plain numbers

Take the 5-day blitz, our most "average" campaign, and follow 10,000 people through it:



3,200 People contacted for every booked call in our most average campaign. Our sharpest campaign did several times better. The difference is the list and the offer, not luck.

That is roughly **3,200 people contacted for every booked call**. Our better campaigns did several times better. The pilot campaign turned 10,284 contacts into 103 opportunities, because the offer and the list were extremely sharp. That gap is the whole game: the same infrastructure, very different results, depending on who you target and what you say.

FROM OUR DASHBOARDS

The industry benchmark backs this up. The sending platform Instantly reports an average reply rate of 3.43%, about 5.5% for the top quarter of senders and 10.7% for the top 10%. Across 588,000 emails, our tuned campaigns landed between 2.8% and 4%.

Your planning worksheet

Fill this in with a pen. Use the "careful" column until you have your own data.

Step	Careful plan	Good campaign	Your number
Calls you want per month	10	10	_____
Interested buyers needed (calls ÷ 0.2)	50	50	_____
Replies needed (interested ÷ share that are interested)	500 (10%)	200 (25%)	_____
People to contact (replies ÷ reply rate)	33,000 (1.5%)	6,700 (3%)	_____
New people per weekday (÷ 21 days)	~1,570	~320	_____

Turn people into inboxes

Each new person gets about 3 emails over 2 to 3 weeks. So your daily sends are roughly **new people per day × 2.5** once the sequence is running. Then divide by a safe volume per inbox.

New people a day	Total sends a day	Inboxes (30 sends each)	Domains (3 inboxes each)
100	~250	9	3
300	~750	25	9
600	~1,500	50	17

PRO TIP

Grow wide, not hard. Never push one inbox past about 30 cold emails a day. When you need more volume, add inboxes and domains. Our 5-day blitz sent 96,408 emails across many warmed inboxes; each single inbox stayed quiet. The total came from width, not intensity.

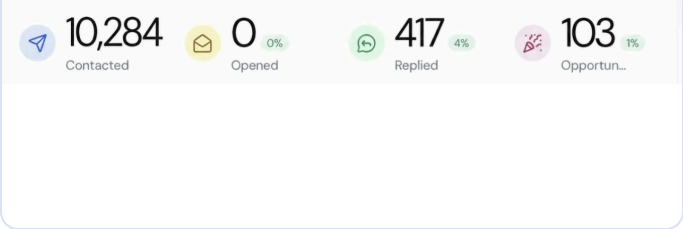
Today's step: fill in the worksheet and write down two numbers: new people per day and the number of inboxes you need.

CASE STUDY 1 OF 7

B2B services · real client · 2026

Why this case is here: it proves the math above with a small, careful test.

103 opportunities from 10,284 people.



The problem. The client wanted proof that cold email could work for their offer before spending on a big campaign.

What we did. One tight list of about 10,000 verified decision makers, one simple offer, and the same manual setup you will build in this playbook.

The result. 417 replies (a 4% reply rate) and **103 opportunities**, about **$150,000 in pipeline**, from just 10,284 people contacted.

10,284	417	4%	103
contacted	replied	reply rate	opportunities

See the live dashboard for this campaign →

COMING UP **Chapter 2: the six tools you need, what each really costs, and the one shortcut that quietly gets accounts shut down.**

CHAPTER 2

Your tool stack and what it really costs

> You need six kinds of tools. None of them are fancy. Here is what each one does, what we use, and a realistic first-month budget.

Job	What it does	Options	Typical cost
Domains	Separate web addresses you send from, so your main domain is never at risk	Namecheap, GoDaddy, Porkbun, Cloudflare	About $10 to $15 per domain per year
Inboxes	Real mailboxes on those domains	Google Workspace (our default), Microsoft 365	Workspace Business Starter: $7/user/mo yearly or $8.40 monthly
Sending platform	Sends sequences from many inboxes, rotates them, runs warmup, collects replies in one place	Instantly, Smartlead, lemlist	Instantly Growth $47/mo; Hypergrowth $97/mo (monthly billing)
Lead data	Finds decision makers and their work emails	Apollo, LinkedIn Sales Navigator, industry directories	Free tiers exist; paid plans from about $50/mo
Verification	Checks every email is real before you send	MillionVerifier, NeverBounce, ZeroBounce	Roughly $3 to $8 per 1,000 emails
Health checks	DNS, blacklists, spam rate, test scores	Google Postmaster Tools, MXToolbox, mail-tester.com	Free

Prices as listed by the vendors in late 2026. They change often, so check before you buy.

A realistic first month

For a starter system of **9 inboxes on 3 domains** (about 100 new people a day, which supports roughly 250 sends a day once warm):

Item	Math	First month
3 domains	3 × ~$12 (paid yearly)	~$36
9 Google Workspace inboxes	9 × $8.40 (monthly)	~$76
Sending platform	One plan with unlimited inboxes and warmup	$47 to $97
Lead data	Free tier, or one paid seat	$0 to $99
Verify 5,000 emails	5 × ~$5	~$25
Total		**about $185 to $335**

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Do not buy "pre-warmed" inboxes from random sellers or use free Gmail accounts for cold outreach. You do not control their history, and Google can shut down accounts that look like they were made for bulk mail. Own your domains, own your inboxes.

Today's step: open accounts with a domain registrar and a sending platform. Do not buy anything else yet.

COMING UP **Chapter 3: why you never send from your main domain, and how to pick domain names buyers trust.**

CHAPTER 3

Buy the right domains

> Never send cold email from your main company domain. You buy look-alike domains that point back to your real business, and you let them take the risk.

Your main domain carries your website, your invoices, your team's email and your brand. If cold outreach damages its reputation, every email your company sends suffers. So every serious outbound team sends from **secondary domains**: close, honest variations of the brand name.

How to pick names

Say your company is **brightroof.com**. Good secondary domains look like this:

Good choice	Why it works	Avoid	Why
trybrightroof.com	Clear, short, obviously your brand	bright-roof-pros.biz	Hyphens and odd endings look spammy
getbrightroof.com	Common prefix, easy to read	brightrooof.com	Typo domains look like phishing
brightroofhq.com	Professional suffix	brightroof.xyz	Cheap endings carry worse reputation
brightroofteam.com	Reads naturally in an email address	roofingdeals4u.com	Hides who you are (a legal problem too)

- [ ] **Buy .com** whenever you can. U.S. buyers trust it most.
- [ ] **Short and easy to say.** The name shows up in every "From" line.
- [ ] **Honest.** The domain must point back to your real company. Hiding who you are breaks U.S. law (Chapter 16).
- [ ] **Buy them yearly with auto-renew on.** A domain that expires in the middle of a campaign kills every inbox on it.
- [ ] **Plan 2 to 3 inboxes per domain.** Spreading out means one bad domain only hurts a small part of your system.

PRO TIP

Buy one or two spare domains on day one and warm them with the rest. When a domain gets tired (and eventually one will), you swap in a warm spare instead of losing three weeks.

Today's step: list 10 name ideas with prefixes (try, get, use, meet) and suffixes (hq, team, co), check each on MXToolbox's blacklist tool, buy what your worksheet says plus one spare, turn on auto-renew and privacy, and log each domain with its renewal date.



Rather skip the setup? Picking domains, buying inboxes and getting the records right is what our team has done every day for 8 years. Book a 20-minute call and we will set it all up for you.

Book a 20-min call →

COMING UP **Chapter 4: setting up the inboxes, and the 10-minute profile step most people skip.**

CHAPTER 4

Google Workspace and your inboxes

> One Workspace account can hold all your sending domains. You add each domain, create 2 to 3 real people on it, and make every inbox look like a person a buyer would trust.

Set up the account

1. Go to Google Workspace and start a **Business Starter** account using your **first secondary domain** (not your main domain). Choose the monthly (Flexible) plan if you want to stay flexible.
2. Google asks you to verify you own the domain. It gives you a TXT record to add at your registrar. Add it, wait a few minutes, click Verify.
3. Add your other secondary domains in the Admin console: **Account → Domains → Manage domains → Add a domain**. Pick "secondary domain" so each one can have its own users. Verify each one the same way.
4. Create users: **Directory → Users → Add new user**. Two or three per domain, using real team members' names where you can.

Name inboxes like people: `ali@trybrightroof.com` or `ali.h@…`. Never sales@, info@ or noreply@: role addresses look like a blast and get filtered more.

Make every inbox look human

This takes ten minutes per inbox and most people skip it. Do not.

- [ ] **Profile photo:** a real, friendly headshot of the person. It shows next to your name in Gmail.
- [ ] **Display name:** "Ali Hassan", not "Ali from BrightRoof Sales Team".
- [ ] **Plain-text signature:** name, title, company, real website, and your postal address (U.S. law requires a physical address in commercial email). No images, no banners, no long legal text.
- [ ] **Sign in once from a normal browser** and send a couple of real emails to colleagues. A brand new inbox that has never been used by a person looks odd.
- [ ] **Turn on 2-step verification** for every user. You will need it in Chapter 6 anyway.

From: Ali Hassan <ali@trybrightroof.com> · **Subject:** signature example

Ali Hassan
Partner, BrightRoof
brightroof.com
123 Main St, Suite 4, Austin, TX 78701

A clean signature: real name, real company, real site, real address. Your main website is fine here; the redirect in Chapter 6 makes the secondary domain point there too.

COMING UP **Chapter 5: the four DNS records that decide whether you land in the inbox or get rejected. Exact values to copy.**

CHAPTER 5

DNS: MX, SPF, DKIM and DMARC

> These four records tell Gmail and Outlook that your emails are really from you. Without them you are not just in spam, you can be rejected outright. Here is each record, what it does, and exactly what to type.

Since February 2024, Google requires every sender to Gmail to have SPF or DKIM set up, and senders of more than 5,000 emails a day to have all three: SPF, DKIM and DMARC. Yahoo has the same rules. Since May 5, 2025, Microsoft rejects high-volume mail to Outlook that fails them, with the error `550 5.7.515`. You do this once per domain. Do all four on every domain, whatever your volume.

You add these at your registrar (Namecheap: **Domain List → Manage → Advanced DNS**; GoDaddy: **My Products → DNS**). Each record has a **Type**, a **Host** (or Name) and a **Value**.

1 · MX record	where your mail is delivered
Type	`MX`
Host	`@`
Value	`smtp.google.com`
Priority	`1`

MX tells the world which server receives mail for your domain. Without it, replies bounce. Google's current setup uses this single MX record. Delete any old MX records your registrar added by default (many add their own email forwarding records).

2 · SPF record	who is allowed to send
Type	TXT
Host	@
Value	v=spf1 include:_spf.google.com ~all

SPF is a guest list. It says "Google's servers may send email for this domain." A domain may have only **one** SPF record. If you already have one, add the include to it instead of creating a second.

3 · DKIM record	a tamper-proof signature
Type	TXT
Host	google._domainkey
Value	v=DKIM1; k=rsa; p=MIIBIjANBg... (long key Google gives you)

DKIM signs every email with a secret key, so the receiver can check nothing was changed and it really came from your domain. You get your key from Google: **Admin console → Apps → Google Workspace → Gmail → Authenticate email**. Pick the domain, choose 2048-bit, click Generate. Paste the record at your registrar, wait about an hour, then come back and click **Start authentication**.

4 · DMARC record	the rulebook and the report
Type	TXT
Host	_dmarc
Value	v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:dmarc@yourmaindomain.com; adkim=r; aspf=r

DMARC tells receivers what to do if an email fails SPF and DKIM, and where to send reports. Start with `p=none` (watch only). `adkim=r; aspf=r` means relaxed matching, which suits Google Workspace. Send the reports to an inbox on your main domain so you see all your domains in one place.

Check your work

1. Wait 30 minutes to a few hours for the records to spread (it can take up to 48 hours).
2. Open MXToolbox and run the **MX Lookup**, **SPF Record Lookup**, **DKIM Lookup** (selector: `google`) and **DMARC Lookup** for each domain. Every test should be green.

3. Send an email from the new inbox to a personal Gmail account. Open it, click the three dots → **Show original**. You want to see **SPF: PASS**, **DKIM: PASS** and **DMARC: PASS**.

4. Go to mail-tester.com, send an email to the address it shows you, and check your score. Aim for 9/10 or better before you go further.

MISTAKE TO AVOID

The two most common mistakes we fix for new clients: **two SPF records** on one domain (both fail), and **DKIM generated but never started** in the Admin console (Google shows "Not authenticating"). Both look fine at a glance and silently push mail to spam.

CASE STUDY 2 OF 7

Construction software · real client · 2026

Why this case is here: Chapters 3 to 5 are exactly what protected this client.

From a cold inbox to 6 signed annual contracts.



The problem. Contractors had never heard of this software company, and the company's main domain carried their quotes, invoices and customer email. Burning it was not an option.

What we did. Separate sending domains with SPF, DKIM and DMARC passing on every one, verified lists and steady daily volume. Their main domain never sent a single cold email.

The result. 4,449 replies (2.81%), **31 qualified demos** and **6 signed annual contracts**, with $15,000 closed so far. About 1 in 5 demos became a contract.

162,073	4,449	31	6
emails sent	replies	qualified demos	annual contracts

See the live dashboard for this campaign →

COMING UP **Chapter 6: three small jobs that finish the machine, including the tracking setting that quietly pushes emails toward spam.**

CHAPTER 6

Redirects, connecting inboxes, tracking

> Three small jobs that finish the machine: make each secondary domain open your real website, connect every inbox to your sending platform, and switch off the tracking that hurts delivery.

1 · Redirect each domain to your real site

Curious buyers type the domain they saw in your email address into a browser. If they land on a parked "this domain is for sale" page, you lose trust. Point every secondary domain to your main website with a permanent (301) redirect.

- **Namecheap:** Domain List → Manage → Redirect Domain → source `trybrightroof.com`, destination `https://brightroof.com`.
- **GoDaddy:** Domain → Forwarding → Add forwarding → https://brightroof.com, type **Permanent (301)**.

The redirect only affects the website. Your MX, SPF, DKIM and DMARC records keep working for email.

2 · Connect inboxes to your sending platform

There are two ways. Use the first if your platform offers it.

Option A: Sign in with Google (OAuth)
In your Workspace Admin console go to **Security → Access and data control → API controls → Manage third-party app access**, find your sending platform and mark it **Trusted**. Then in the platform click "Add account → Google" and sign in for each inbox. No passwords stored, fewer disconnects.

Option B: App password (IMAP/SMTP)
Make sure 2-step verification is on. Sign in to the inbox, open **Google Account → Security → App passwords**, create one named after your platform and paste the 16-character code into the platform with `imap.gmail.com` (port 993) and `smtp.gmail.com` (port 587).

When each inbox is connected, set its daily limit in the platform. Start at the warmup numbers in Chapter 7, never at the maximum.

3 · Turn tracking off

Open tracking works by hiding a tiny invisible image in your email. Link tracking rewrites your links through a tracking server. Both make a cold email look more like marketing mail to spam filters, and Apple Mail privacy makes open numbers unreliable anyway.

FROM OUR DASHBOARDS

Our dashboards show **zero opens** on purpose. We switched open tracking off on every campaign and judge copy by replies and booked calls only, the numbers that pay the bills. If you must use link tracking, set up a custom tracking domain (a CNAME record your platform gives you) so you are not sharing a tracking address with thousands of other senders.

SHORT ON TIME?



Skip the setup. We build the whole machine for you.

Domains, inboxes, DNS, warmup and daily monitoring, done by a team with 8 years in outbound. Book a free 20-minute call with our CEO and see what we would build for you.

Book my 20-minute call →

COMING UP **Chapter 7: the 3-week warmup schedule, and the client it paid off for with 25 booked calls in 5 days.**

CHAPTER 7

Warmup: the 3-week rule

> A brand-new inbox that suddenly sends hundreds of emails looks like a spammer. Warmup builds a normal-looking history first. It is the step most people rush, and the reason most campaigns die.

Google's own guidance is direct: start with low volume, increase slowly, and avoid sudden spikes if you have no history of sending. Warmup is how you build that history. Your sending platform sends small numbers of emails between your inbox and a network of real inboxes. Those emails get opened, replied to, and pulled out of spam when they land there. That tells Gmail and Outlook that people want mail from you.

The schedule we use

Week	Warmup emails per inbox per day	Cold emails per inbox per day	What you are doing
1	5 → 15, rising a little each day	0	Records checked, profiles finished, warmup on
2	15 → 25	0	Build and verify your list, write your emails
3	25 → 35	0	Test placement with a few manual emails
4	Keep at ~20 to 30	10 → 15	First campaign, small batches
5	Keep at ~20 to 30	15 → 25	Watch bounces and replies daily
6+	Keep running in the background	Up to ~30	Scale by adding inboxes, not volume

- [ ] **14 days is the minimum. 21 is safer.** If you are in a hurry, the answer is more inboxes, not less warmup.
- [ ] **Never turn warmup off** after launch. It keeps your sending pattern steady on quiet days.

MISTAKE TO AVOID

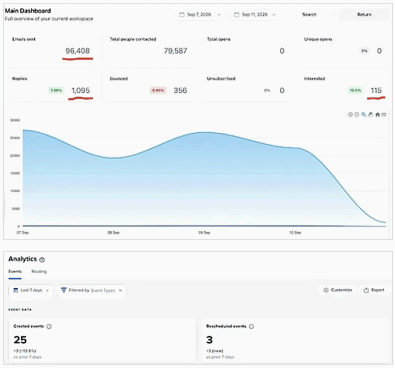
Starting campaigns on day 5 because "the records are green". Green records mean you are allowed to send. They do not mean you are trusted. We see this more than any other mistake.

CASE STUDY 3 OF 7

Fast-turnaround client · real client · 2026

Why this case is here: this is what three weeks of patient warmup buys you.

96,408 emails. Five days. 25 calls on the calendar.



The problem. The client needed sales meetings fast, inside a single week.

What we did. Because the inboxes were already warm and the list was verified, we spread a five-day push across many inboxes while each one stayed at a modest volume.

The result. 96,408 emails in 5 days to 79,587 people, a bounce rate of just **0.45%**, 1,095 replies, 115 interested buyers and **25 booked calls in one week**, about $62,500 in pipeline.

96,408	1,095	115	25
emails in 5 days	replies	interested	calls booked

See the live dashboard for this campaign →

COMING UP **Chapter 8: the 10-minute morning check we run for every client, so problems show up before your results drop.**

CHAPTER 8

The 10-minute daily health check

> A cold email system is like a car engine: it rarely breaks all at once, it warns you first. This is the routine we run every morning for every client. Ten minutes, before you touch anything else.

Check	Where	Healthy	Act now if
Bounce rate per campaign	Sending platform	under 2%	near 3% pause and re-verify the list
Disconnected inboxes	Sending platform → accounts	All connected	Any error: reconnect today
Warmup health	Sending platform → warmup	Steady, high	Drops for 2 days: cut that inbox's cold volume
Replies waiting	Unified inbox	Interested answered within 1 hour	Anything older than 1 business day
Opt-outs	Replies + unsubscribe list	Added to suppression list same day	Any opt-out still active in a campaign
Spam rate	Google Postmaster Tools	under 0.1%	near 0.3% Google's hard limit

Once a week: blacklist check on MXToolbox, a mail-tester score of 9/10+, a manual placement test (your campaign email sent to your own Gmail, Outlook and Yahoo test inboxes), and a look at domain renewal dates. The full weekly checklist is at the end.

Google Postmaster Tools (free): add each sending domain, prove ownership with the TXT record Google gives you, and check weekly. Google notes it may show no data on low-volume days, which is normal for one cold domain.

FROM OUR DASHBOARDS

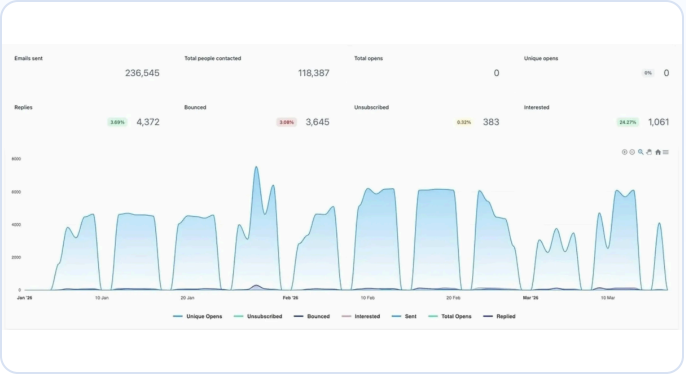
Our dashboards show bounce rates between **0.45%** and **3.08%** across campaigns. The lowest came from a fresh, verified list. The highest came from a quarter that mixed in older data, which is exactly why we now re-verify any list older than about 60 days. The daily check is how we caught it before it turned into a spam problem.

CASE STUDY 4 OF 7

High-volume program · real client · 2026

Why this case is here: daily checks are what keep volume like this out of spam.

1,061 interested leads in one quarter.



The problem. The client wanted a reliable stream of interested buyers every week for a whole quarter, not one big spike.

What we did. Consistent daily sending across many inboxes, list hygiene before every batch, constant testing and the daily health check above.

The result. 236,545 emails, 4,372 replies (3.69%) and **1,061 interested buyers** in one quarter, about **$100,000 in pipeline**. Its 3.08% bounce rate, our highest, came from older data, so we now re-verify lists older than 60 days.

236,545	4,372	3.69%	1,061
emails sent	replies	reply rate	interested

See the live dashboard for this campaign →



Want the whole machine built and watched for you? Our experts with 8 years in outbound set up, warm up and check every inbox every morning, so you never have to.

Book a 20-min call →

COMING UP **Part 3, the list: why the right list beats the perfect email, and how to find buyers who need you right now.**

CHAPTER 9

Pick buyers who are ready now

> Start with the customers who already pay you, not a wish list. Then add a "trigger": a public sign that a company needs you right now.

Write your ideal customer profile (ICP)

Pull up your five best customers, the ones who paid well, stayed long and were easy to work with. Fill in this table for them. The patterns are your ICP.

Question	Example: construction software client	Your answer
Industry	General contractors, commercial construction	_____
Company size	20 to 200 employees	_____
Location	USA, specific states	_____
Who signs	Owner, VP of Operations, Project Executive	_____
The painful problem	Losing time and margin on manual project tracking	_____
Proof you can show	Case study from a similar contractor	_____

Add a trigger

A trigger turns "a good fit" into "a good fit right now". It also gives you an honest reason to write.

- **Hiring:** a job post for the role you help with means budget and pain.
- **Growth:** a new location, funding, a big contract, a press release.
- **Change:** a new leader in the buyer seat in the last 90 days.
- **Tools:** their site or job posts show a tool you replace or plug into.

COMING UP **Chapter 10: building and verifying the list by hand, so your bounce rate stays under 2%.**

CHAPTER 10

Build and verify the list by hand

> Lists you buy in bulk are full of dead emails and wrong people. We build every list in small segments, check it by eye, and verify every single address before it goes near a campaign.

Where to find people

- **Lead databases** (Apollo and similar): filter by industry, size, location and job title. Export in batches of a few hundred, one segment at a time.
- **LinkedIn Sales Navigator:** the most up-to-date job titles. Use it to confirm the person is still in the role.
- **Industry directories:** state contractor license boards, chamber of commerce lists, Clutch for agencies, association member lists.
- **Google Maps:** great for local service businesses (owner names are often on the website's About page).

Columns every list needs: first name, company, title, verified work email, website, city and state (to send in their time zone), the trigger, and a first line written by a person after a two-minute look, e.g. *"Saw Carter is hiring two PMs for the new Aurora job."*

Clean before you verify

- [ ] **Remove role addresses** such as info@, sales@, office@, admin@. Low replies, high complaints.
- [ ] **One or two people per company**, maximum. Ten emails into one company look like a blast and annoy the buyer.
- [ ] **Remove anyone outside your target country.** Different countries have different laws (Chapter 16).
- [ ] **Remove past opt-outs, customers and competitors** using your suppression list.

Verify every address

Upload the list to a verification tool. It sorts emails into groups. Here is what we do with each:

Result	What it means	What we do
Valid	The mailbox exists	Send
Invalid	The mailbox does not exist	Delete
Catch-all	The server accepts everything, so the tool cannot tell	Hold separate small campaign later, or skip
Unknown	The server did not answer	Hold re-check in a few days

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Sending to an old list "because it was verified last year". People change jobs every day. Re-verify anything older than about 60 days. Bounce rate is the fastest way to burn a new domain: keep it under 2% and pause near 3%.

CASE STUDY 5 OF 7

Marketing agency · real client · 2026

Why this case is here: a clear buyer and a clean list, worked every single day.

2,146 people said "Yes, tell me more."



The problem. A marketing agency needed a steady flow of conversations with business owners every week, not now and then.

What we did. A tight business-owner list that got sharper every week, verified before every batch and sent steadily every weekday.

The result. About **100 interested replies every week**: 2,429 replies and **2,146 interested buyers** from 76,081 people, about **$175,000 in pipeline**, with a 1.64% bounce rate.

82,671	2,429	2,146	$175,000
emails sent	replies	interested	pipeline

See the live dashboard for this campaign →



No time to build lists by hand? We find, check and verify every buyer for you, the same way we did for the campaigns in this playbook. Book a 20-minute call with our CEO.

Book a 20-min call →

COMING UP **Part 4, the message: the 5-part email formula, with examples you can copy.**

CHAPTER 11

Write emails people answer

> Five parts, under 80 words, plain text, no images, at most one link. That is the whole formula. The hard part is saying something specific.

Part	Job	Rule
Subject	Get opened	2 to 5 words, lowercase, looks like an internal email: "pm hiring at carter"
First line	Prove it is not a blast	About them, not you. Their trigger, their company, their work.
Problem	Make it relevant	One problem people like them have, in their words.
Proof	Make it believable	One short result from a similar company. A number beats an adjective.
Ask	Make replying easy	Ask for interest, not a meeting: "worth a look?", "open to it?"

Example 1: a home services software company to a roofing owner

From: Ali Hassan <ali@trybrightroof.com> · **Subject:** storm season leads

Hi Mark,

Saw Carter Roofing is hiring two estimators ahead of storm season.

Most roofing owners we talk to lose good jobs in that rush because quotes go out two or three days late.

A Denver roofer using our quoting tool cut their quote time to same-day and won 11 more jobs last spring.

Worth a quick look before the season starts?

Ali

Sample email for a fictional company. 72 words. First line is about Mark, not us. One problem, one proof, one easy question. No link, no image, no attachment.

Personalize in three layers: (1) one version per **segment**, such as owners vs. operations leaders; (2) a **company** line about their trigger, written by a person after a two-minute look; (3) a **person** line about something they said or did, saved for your most valuable accounts.

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Fake "Re:" or "Fwd:" subjects, spammy words in the subject ("free", "guaranteed", "act now"), images, attachments and three links in the first email. Each one makes a filter, or a buyer, less likely to trust you.

FROM OUR DASHBOARDS

Across 588,000 emails, our tuned campaigns earned reply rates between **2.8% and 4%** with plain-text emails under 100 words, one problem and one proof line. The pilot campaign reached a 4.05% reply rate and **103 opportunities** from just 10,284 people contacted, about $150,000 in pipeline.

COMING UP **Chapter 12: the follow-ups. Nearly half of all replies come after the first email.**

CHAPTER 12

Follow-ups that add something new

> Almost half of all replies come after the first email. But "just bumping this" is not a follow-up. Every email in the sequence must add a new reason to reply.

Instantly's benchmark data shows about **58% of replies come from the first email and 42% from follow-ups**. Stop after one email and you leave nearly half your results on the table.

The schedule

Email	Day	What it adds	Length
1	Day 1	The five-part email from Chapter 11	Under 80 words
2	Day 3 or 4	A different angle on the same problem, or a second proof point	Under 60 words
3	Day 7 or 8	A useful resource or a specific idea for their company	Under 60 words
4	Day 11 to 14	A short story: how one similar client got a result	Under 70 words
5	Day 18 to 21	A polite close: "should I stop reaching out?"	Under 40 words

Send follow-ups in the **same thread** (reply to your own email) so the context stays with them.

From: Ali Hassan · **Subject:** Re: storm season leads

Hi Mark, I have not heard back, so I will assume the timing is off.

Should I close the loop for now, or is it worth checking back in the fall?

Ali

The last email. Short and respectful. It often gets the "yes, check back in August" reply that turns into a deal later.

PRO TIP

Stop the sequence the moment anyone replies, even with "not interested". Your sending platform does this automatically if replies are connected. A follow-up sent after a "no" is how complaints happen.

WANT YOUR CAMPAIGN WRITTEN BY PEOPLE WHO DO THIS DAILY?



Get the emails, the list and the follow-ups done for you.

We write, test and send every email, handle every reply, and book qualified buyers into your calendar. Book a 20-minute strategy call with our CEO.

Book a 20-minute call →

COMING UP **Part 5: launch day, the slow ramp, and turning replies into booked meetings.**

CHAPTER 13

Launch day and the volume ramp

> Start smaller than you want, watch everything, then grow a little each week. A slow first two weeks protects months of sending.

Campaign settings that matter

- [ ] **Sending window:** weekdays, roughly 8 a.m. to 5 p.m. in the **buyer's** time zone. A CFO in Denver should not get your email at 6 a.m. Mountain because your tool runs on Eastern.
- [ ] **Daily limit per inbox:** the ramp numbers from Chapter 7, never the platform's maximum.
- [ ] **Gap between emails:** randomize it (for example every 8 to 15 minutes per inbox) so sending looks human.
- [ ] **Text only**, open tracking off, link tracking off.
- [ ] **Stop on reply** turned on, including auto-replies that say the person left the company.
- [ ] **Unsubscribe handling:** an opt-out line in every email and replies like "remove me" sent straight to your suppression list.

The first 14 days: start at 5 to 10 new people per inbox per day, move to 10 to 15 in week two, then up to about 30 total sends. If any batch bounces above 3%, stop and re-verify. Read every early reply; they tell you if the message lands.

COMING UP **Chapter 14: what to write back when someone says yes, and how to make sure they actually show up.**

CHAPTER 14

From reply to booked meeting

> Replies are where meetings are won or lost. Speed and a helpful answer beat a clever email every single time.

Sort every reply into a bucket

Bucket	Example	What we do	How fast
Interested	"Sure, tell me more"	Answer their question, then offer two times	Within 1 hour
Wants info	"Send me pricing"	Give a real, short answer and ask one question back	Same day
Not now	"Try me next quarter"	Thank them, set a reminder, write back on that date	Same day
Wrong person	"Talk to Sarah"	Write Sarah, mention who sent you	Same day
No	"Not interested"	Short thank-you, stop all emails	Same day
Opt-out	"Remove me"	Suppression list, no reply needed	Same day (law: within 10 business days)

Replies that book the call

From: Ali Hassan · **Subject:** Re: storm season leads

Hi Mark, glad it is timely.

Short version: we connect to the tool you already use for measurements, and the quote goes out the same day.

Easiest is a 20-minute screen share. Does Tuesday at 10:00 or Wednesday at 2:00 Mountain work? Or grab any time here: [booking link]

Ali

Answer first, then two specific times in their time zone, then a link as a backup.

Protect the show rate

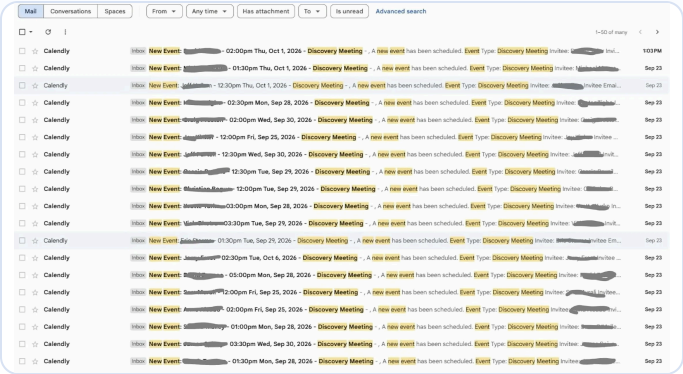
- [ ] Book within **2 to 4 business days**. Interest cools fast.
- [ ] Send a **confirmation** right away, a **reminder the day before** and a short note **an hour before**.
- [ ] When someone does not show, send a friendly, no-guilt reschedule message **within 24 hours**.
- [ ] Track **show rate** (meetings held ÷ booked) as its own number.

CASE STUDY 6 OF 7

The end result · real client · 2026

Why this is here: this is what the whole system is for.

50+ discovery calls in one client's calendar.



The goal. Not opens, not replies: qualified buyers on the calendar.

What we did. Interested replies answered fast, two time options offered, confirmations and reminders sent, no-shows rescheduled within 24 hours.

The result. Every line in this screenshot is a real Calendly booking: **50+ calls** in one client's calendar.

See the real bookings →



Would you rather just get the meetings? We answer every reply and book qualified buyers straight into your calendar. 8 years of doing exactly this. Book a 20-minute call.

Book a 20-min call →

COMING UP **Chapter 15: how to read your numbers, and which test to run first (hint: it is not the subject line).**

CHAPTER 15

Testing and reading your numbers

> Change one thing at a time, give each test enough people, and judge it by positive replies, never by opens.

What to test, in order

1. **The list** (segment, title, trigger). Biggest impact by far.
2. **The offer and the angle** (which problem you lead with).
3. **The proof** (which result you mention).
4. **The ask** ("worth a look?" vs. "open to a 15-minute call?").
5. **The subject line.** Smallest impact, so test it last.

Send each version to at least **1,000 people**, judge by **positive replies per 1,000** (an angry reply is still a reply), and keep a simple test log.

The numbers that matter

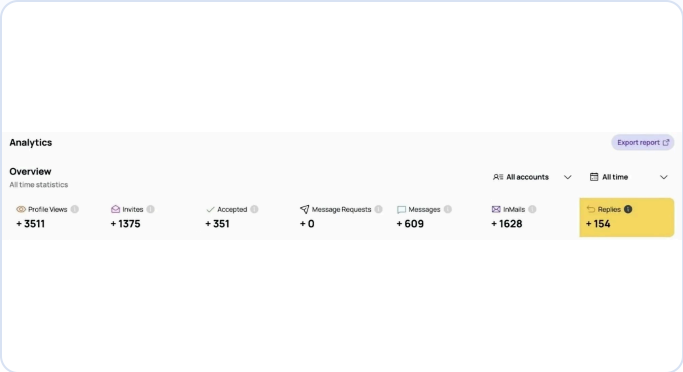
Metric	How to calculate	Healthy range from our campaigns
Bounce rate	Bounces ÷ emails sent	0.45% to 3%; aim under 2%
Reply rate	Replies ÷ people contacted	2.8% to 4% when tuned
Interested rate	Interested ÷ replies	10% to 25% is common
Show rate	Held ÷ booked	Track it weekly
Cost per qualified meeting	Total spend ÷ qualified meetings held	The number to compare any option by

CASE STUDY 7 OF 7

Founders and investors · real client · 2026

Why this case is here: when the numbers say your buyers do not live in the inbox, change the channel, not the effort.

154 replies from founders and investors.



The problem. Founders and angel investors are one of the hardest audiences to reach, and many rarely answer cold email.

What we did. LinkedIn outreach alongside email: connection invites and InMails written with the same rules as Chapter 11 (short, about them, one easy question).

The result. 1,375 invites, 351 accepted, 1,628 InMails and **154 replies** from people who almost never answer cold email, about $7,500 in pipeline.

1,375	351	1,628	154
invites	accepted	InMails	replies

See the live dashboard for this campaign →



Want experts to test and tune it for you? We run the tests, read the numbers and fix what is not working, every week. Book a 20-minute call and see what we would change.

Book a 20-min call →

COMING UP **Part 6: the law in plain English (one mistake can cost up to $53,088 per email), and what to do when emails hit spam.**

CHAPTER 16

The law: USA and Canada

> Cold B2B email is legal in the U.S. when you follow the CAN-SPAM Act. Canada is stricter. Here are the rules in plain English.

NOT LEGAL ADVICE

This is general information based on the FTC's published guidance and the law as of October 2026. Talk to a qualified attorney about your situation.

USA: CAN-SPAM in seven rules

1. **No B2B exception.** The FTC says the law "makes no exception for business-to-business email."
2. **Honest headers.** The From name, address and domain must identify you or your business.
3. **Honest subject lines.** No fake "Re:" or fake invoices.
4. **Say it is an ad** in a clear way that fits your style. Decide how with your counsel and apply it to every template.
5. **A valid physical postal address** in every email (street address, registered P.O. box or registered private mailbox).
6. **A clear way to opt out**, which you honor within **10 business days** and which keeps working for at least 30 days after you send.
7. **You stay responsible** even if an agency sends for you. Both can be liable.

$53,088 The maximum U.S. civil penalty for **each** email that breaks CAN-SPAM.

One unhonored opt-out in a big campaign is an expensive mistake.

Canada: CASL is stricter

Canada's anti-spam law needs consent before you send. For B2B there is a narrow form of implied consent: the person's email address is published publicly (for example on their company website), with no statement that they do not want messages, and your message is relevant to their job. You must also identify yourself, include contact details and an unsubscribe that works. If you cannot show that kind of consent, do not email them.

COMING UP Chapter 17: the 7-step plan we use when a domain starts landing in spam.

CHAPTER 17

When emails hit spam

> Every system has a bad week. What matters is spotting it early and fixing it calmly. Here is our recovery plan, step by step.

Warning signs: replies drop while volume stays the same, your placement test lands in spam or Promotions, warmup health falls for 2+ days, or bounces jump above 3% / Postmaster spam rate climbs toward 0.3%.

The 7-step recovery

1. **Pause new campaigns** on the affected inboxes. Keep warmup running.
2. **Check the records** with "Show original" on a real email: SPF, DKIM and DMARC must all pass.
3. **Check bounces and complaints.** Re-verify the list if bounces are high.
4. **Strip the email**: remove links, tracking and anything salesy in the subject.
5. **Check blacklists** on MXToolbox for the domain.
6. **Restart small:** a few emails a day per inbox, test placement, then ramp up over 1 to 2 weeks.
7. **Retire the domain** if it does not recover. This is why you use secondary domains: swap in your warm spare and move on.

WHAT OUR DASHBOARDS TAUGHT US

Our highest bounce rate (3.08%) came from a quarter where older data was mixed into the list. That is why we now re-verify any list older than about 60 days before it goes near a campaign.



ALREADY STUCK IN SPAM?

Get a free review of your setup.

On a 20-minute call with our CEO we look at your domains, records and numbers and tell you honestly what we would change. If you want us to fix it, we can. If not, you keep the advice.

Book my free review →

YOUR TOOLS

The 30-day calendar and checklists

> Print these pages. Tick the boxes. This is the exact order we follow for every new client.

Days	What gets done	Chapter
1	Worksheet filled in; registrar and sending platform accounts opened	1, 2
2	Domains bought (plus one spare), auto-renew on, system sheet started	3
3 to 4	Google Workspace set up, domains verified, users created, profiles and signatures done	4
4 to 5	MX, SPF, DKIM, DMARC added; DKIM started; all tests green; mail-tester 9/10+	5
5	Redirects live, inboxes connected, tracking off, warmup on	6, 7
6 to 12	ICP and triggers written; first list segment built, cleaned and verified	9, 10
13 to 18	Emails and follow-ups written for each segment; reply templates ready	11, 12, 14
19 to 21	Placement tests; Postmaster Tools set up; suppression list ready; final checklist	8, 16
22	Launch: 5 to 10 new people per inbox per day	13
23 to 30	Daily health check every morning; reply within an hour; slow ramp	8, 13, 14

Pre-launch checklist

- [ ] Main domain is not used for any cold email
- [ ] Every domain passes SPF, DKIM, DMARC
- [ ] Only one SPF record per domain
- [ ] Every inbox warmed for at least 14 days
- [ ] Profile photo, real name, plain signature with address
- [ ] Redirects point to your real site
- [ ] Open and link tracking off
- [ ] List verified within the last 60 days
- [ ] Role addresses and duplicates removed
- [ ] Suppression list loaded
- [ ] Opt-out line in every email
- [ ] Sending window set to the buyer's time zone
- [ ] Stop-on-reply turned on
- [ ] Placement test landed in the inbox

Daily (10 minutes)

- [ ] Bounce rate under 2% on every campaign
- [ ] No disconnected inboxes
- [ ] Warmup health steady
- [ ] Interested replies answered within an hour
- [ ] Opt-outs added to suppression list

Weekly

- [ ] Blacklist check on every domain
- [ ] mail-tester score 9/10+
- [ ] Manual placement test (Gmail, Outlook, Yahoo)
- [ ] Test log updated, one decision made
- [ ] Domain renewal dates checked
- [ ] Show rate and cost per meeting reviewed

THE CHOICE

Do it yourself, or let us do it

> You now have the full method. It works. It is also a lot of daily, careful work. Here is the honest comparison.

Do it yourself

- About 30 days from zero to first booked call
- 1 to 2 hours a day once running: checks, replies, lists, testing
- Roughly $185 to $335 a month in tools to start
- You learn by trial and error, and some errors cost a domain
- Great if you have time and want to own the skill

Everything you need is in this playbook. Go for it.

Let WayneFlow do it

- A team with **8 years** in outbound and B2B appointment setting
- We have run campaigns for **dozens of companies** in the USA and Canada
- **588,000 emails** sent and **$510K+** in client pipeline in 2026 alone
- We build the domains, inboxes, records, warmup, lists and emails
- We answer every reply and book qualified buyers into your calendar
- You spend your time on sales calls, not DNS records

588,000	12,900+	3,400+	$510K+
cold emails sent for clients	replies from buyers	buyers who asked to talk	pipeline for clients

FREE · 20 MINUTES · NO PRESSURE

Book a 20-minute session with our CEO



We look at your offer and your market, then show you who we would target, the angle we would use and how many meetings to expect. Even if you decide to do it yourself, you leave with a clear plan. One good client from this system can be worth thousands of dollars.

Book my call →

Or open this link: calendly.com/learnwithasimshah · See every live dashboard at wayne-flow.site/results

© 2026 WayneFlow by Ali & Asim. All campaign numbers come from real client dashboards in 2026; pipeline is counted at our clients' average deal size of about $2,500. Past results do not guarantee future results; your results depend on your offer, market and execution. Tool names and prices belong to their owners and were checked in October 2026. This playbook is general information, not legal advice.